

Kingdom Design: The Seven Factions

Philosophy

Each kingdom represents a distinct race-based faction with unique visual identity, mechanical themes, and playstyle. All kingdoms progress through the same Ages, but their interpretation of each era differs thematically.

1. Humans

Status: Baseline / Balanced

Visual Theme: Medieval European, Roman, Napoleonic (Age-dependent)

Design Principles

- Jack-of-all-trades, no extreme strengths or weaknesses
- Strong organization and formation bonuses
- Technology-focused: humans advance through ages most efficiently
- Heroes tend to be leaders/buffing types

Example Heroes

- ****Knight Captain**** (Melee Tank + Aura Buffs)
- ****Royal Archer**** (Ranged DPS)
- ****Field Marshal**** (Strategic Buffs, Formation Abilities)

2. Kingdom of Ores (Dwarves)

Visual Theme: Mountain holds, runic magic, heavy metal, beards, steam/mechanical contraptions in later ages

Design Principles

- Highest armor and HP in the game
- Slow movement speed
- Superior siege and defensive capabilities
- Runes provide passive buffs and resistances
- Masters of technology and craftsmanship

Racial Traits

- +30% Armor
- -20% Movement Speed
- Can build defensive structures faster
- Units cost more but are more durable

Example Heroes

- **Iron Lord** (Ultra-heavy tank with runic shields)
- **Runesmith** (Support: applies buffs/debuffs through runes)
- **Slayer** (Berserker-type, high damage but low defense)

3. Kingdom of Magic (Elves + Wizards + Gnomes)

Visual Theme: Forests, crystalline structures, glowing magic, nature spirits, arcane laboratories

Design Principles

- Highest magic damage and magic defense
- Lowest physical armor and HP
- Excellent ranged units and spellcasters
- Nature magic (Elves) vs Arcane magic (Wizards) vs Gadgets (Gnomes)

Sub-factions

Sub-faction	Theme	Strength
Wood Elves	Nature, forest spirits	Nature magic, camouflage, ranged
High Elves	Arcane, crystalline	Pure magic damage, shields
Gnomes	Alchemy, gadgets	Mechanical contraptions, explosives

Example Heroes

- **Arcanist** (Pure magic DPS, shield breaker)
- **Forest Warden** (Nature control, roots, summons)
- **Gnome Tinkerer** (Deploys gadgets, mines, turrets)

4. Kingdom of Evil (Necromancers + Witches + Goblins)

Visual Theme: Dark fortresses, bones, shadows, green fire, swarms, undead

Design Principles

- Swarm tactics: weak individual units but summoned in numbers
- Necromancy: raise dead enemies as allies
- Curses and debuffs are primary tools
- Sacrifice mechanics: hurt your own units for powerful effects

Sub-factions

Sub-faction	Theme	Strength
Necromancers	Undead, death magic	Raise dead, drain life, fear

Witches	Curses, poisons	Debuffs, area denial, transformations
Goblins	Swarms, explosives	Cheap, numerous, kamikaze units

Example Heroes

- ****Lich Lord**** (Undead summoner, death aura)
- ****Blight Witch**** (Poison/curses, area denial)
- ****Goblin Warboss**** (Swarm buffs, kamikaze buffs)

5. Kingdom of the Ancients (Silurian + Dinosaurs)

Visual Theme: Jungle, primitive stone tools, dinosaurs, beast riding, tribal markings

Design Principles

- Primitive but powerful
- No magic, no advanced armor
- Dinosaur cavalry is unmatched in charge damage
- Beast synergy: heroes buff nearby dinosaur/beast units

Racial Traits

- No magic damage, no magic defense
- +50% Charge damage
- Units are cheap but technologically limited
- Cannot advance past certain tech in later ages without external help

Example Heroes

- ****Dino-Rider Chieftain**** (Heavy cavalry on T-Rex mount)
- ****Beast Shaman**** (Buffs beasts, summons animal spirits)
- ****Tribal Warmaster**** (Melee berserker, rallying cry)

6. Kingdom of the Beasts (Minotaurs, Trolls, Balrogs, Dragons, Serpents)

Visual Theme: Dark caves, volcanic areas, massive monsters, primal fury

Design Principles

- Individual units are the strongest in the game
- Very expensive, very low unit counts
- Terror mechanics: enemy units may panic
- Regeneration on most units
- No ranged units (except dragons)

Racial Traits

- +100% HP compared to human equivalents
- Units cost 3x as much

- Maximum army size is halved
- Regenerate 1% HP per second out of combat

Example Heroes

- **Minotaur King** (Melee terror, charge through lines)
- **Dragon Ancient** (Flying, fire breath, terror)
- **Balrog Lord** (Fire aura, whip, massive AOE)
- **Serpent Queen** (Poison, constrict, water bonuses)

7. Kingdom of the Divines (Gods, Angels, Demigods, Oracles, Archangels)

Visual Theme: Golden light, clouds, divine architecture, halos, wings

Design Principles

- Most powerful individual units
- Extremely expensive
- Holy damage is effective against undead and demons
- Healing and resurrection abilities
- Limited numbers: divine units are rare

Racial Traits

- Holy damage bonus vs Evil kingdom
- Self-healing and ally-healing
- Can resurrect fallen allies (cooldown limited)
- Units cost 5x human equivalents
- Maximum 3 divine heroes per army

Example Heroes

- **Paladin** (Heavy tank, holy damage, divine shield)
- **Archangel** (Flying, sword of light, resurrection)
- **Oracle** (Support: prophecy buffs, reveal map, counter-spells)
- **Demigod** (Melee/Range hybrid, extremely powerful, game-winning unit)

Kingdom Balance Matrix

	Ores	Magic	Evil	Ancients	Be
	Good	Even	Good	Good	Po
	—	Good	Good	Good	Eve
	Poor	—	Good	Excellent	Po
	Poor	Poor	—	Good	Go
	Poor	Poor	Poor	—	Eve
	Even	Good	Poor	Even	—

	Good	Even	Excellent	Good	Po
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Age Progression by Kingdom

Classical Age

Kingdom	Theme
Humans	Roman-style legions
Ores	Early mountain clans
Magic	Nature spirits, druids
Evil	Tribal necromancers
Ancients	Stone age dinosaurs
Beasts	Cave monsters
Divines	Early temples, prophets

Medieval Age

Kingdom	Theme
Humans	Knights, castles, crusades
Ores	Rune armor, steam engines
Magic	Wizard towers, enchanted forests
Evil	Dark castles, plagues
Ancients	Tamed dinosaurs, tribal empires
Beasts	Monster lairs, dragon hoards
Divines	Paladins, angelic hosts

Mythic Age

Kingdom	Theme
Humans	Legendary heroes, divine right kings
Ores	Forge gods, magma forges
Magic	Archmages, planar magic
Evil	Lich kings, demon gates
Ancients	Primal beasts, world spirits
Beasts	Ancient dragons, titans
Divines	God avatars, celestial armies